Activity: Which tool for the task?

Complete text version

Build a preparation plan for four customer conversations at Solitude Innovations. Match each task to a sales enablement tool.

Select a task beside the central screen. Choose the audience, purpose and tool, then check your plan. Use the hint to revise a choice before completing the task.

A tick, a short completion sound and an updated progress count confirm each completed task. Select Continue when you are ready for the next one. You can turn the sound off.

This is practice, not a test. Your choices and optional rationale stay in this tab and clear when you reload or start again. Do not enter personal or client information.

How to use the text version

For each task, note the audience, purpose, tool and your reason. Read the task before consulting its review section. If a choice does not fit, use the hint to revise it. Compare your final plan with the explanations when you are ready. This text version contains all tasks, choices, hints and completed-plan explanations; it is not graded.

Your four tools

- Pitch deck - Customer-facing - Tell a business story live
- One-pager - Customer-facing - Share a concise follow-up
- Objection-handling guide - Internal - Prepare responses to concerns
- Product quick-reference sheet - Internal - Check specific product facts

Check the plan

Check three things: the tool serves the audience you selected; it supports the purpose you selected; both settings match the task. A task is complete only when all three checks and the tool choice fit. If you change a completed plan, check it again. In the interactive version a tick, progress count and optional sound mark completion. Select Continue to move on; nothing advances automatically.

Task 1: Opening the first presentation

You are preparing your first presentation to a client's leadership team, after the discovery call. The leadership team is cautious about adopting new technology and hesitant to commit without clear business outcomes. The company's online platform slows down during peak shopping events. You need to make a strong impression by connecting cloud benefits, such as scalability and reliability, to measurable business results rather than technical features.

Which tool do you prepare for this meeting?

Where in the sale is this?

What information do you need?

Who will see it?

Choose an audience: Customer-facing or Internal.

Choose a purpose: Tell a business story live; Share a concise follow-up; Prepare responses to concerns; Check specific product facts.

Choose a tool: Pitch deck; One-pager; Objection-handling guide; Product quick-reference sheet.

Retry hints - read after choosing

One-pager: This choice assumes the main conversation has already happened. Recheck where you are in the sales process.

Objection-handling guide: You have prepared for questions, but the leadership team has not yet seen your proposal. What must the opening achieve?

Product quick-reference sheet: A list of details will not establish why this proposal matters to this leadership team. What should they understand first?

Completed-plan explanation - compare when ready

Audience: Customer-facing. Purpose: Tell a business story live. Tool: Pitch deck.

A pitch deck tells a focused story that connects the client's problem to your solution. Its typical sections are a company overview, the customer challenge, a solution overview and proof points. For a cautious leadership team, the customer challenge slide puts the slow platform in business terms, and the proof points show results rather than features. That is what an introductory meeting needs to capture attention.

Where in the sale is this? The opening presentation, after discovery and before the client has heard your solution.

What information do you need? The client's challenge framed in business terms, a relevant solution and documented evidence, if available, to support the proposed value. Scalability and reliability are capabilities you have explored this week.

Who will see it? The client's leadership team, live in the meeting.

Task 2: A summary for senior management

You are following up after an initial presentation. The client's operations director wants a concise summary to share with senior management before approving another meeting. The client is exploring cloud analytics to improve product development and needs something short she can pass on, linking relevant capabilities to goals such as speed, security and compliance.

Which tool do you send the operations director?

Where in the sale is this?

What information do you need?

Who will see it?

Choose an audience: Customer-facing or Internal.

Choose a purpose: Tell a business story live; Share a concise follow-up; Prepare responses to concerns; Check specific product facts.

Choose a tool: Pitch deck; One-pager; Objection-handling guide; Product quick-reference sheet.

Retry hints - read after choosing

Pitch deck: Who will present this to the decision-makers? Check whether your choice can work without you in the room.

Objection-handling guide: Does this material address what the operations director wants to pass on, or a different preparation need?

Product quick-reference sheet: Would these details help the director explain the proposed value and next step? Recheck the request.

Completed-plan explanation - compare when ready

Audience: Customer-facing. Purpose: Share a concise follow-up. Tool: One-pager.

A one-pager reinforces key messages after a meeting. It typically includes a headline and value statement, relevant features, supporting evidence if available, and a call to action. Here it can summarise how proposed capabilities relate to the client's goals without promising outcomes that have not been established. A single page is easy to share with senior management, as Eli Chen demonstrated with his follow-up one-pager.

Where in the sale is this? Straight after the first presentation, before the client agrees to the next meeting.

What information do you need? The main message in a form the operations director can pass to people who were not in the room.

Who will see it? The operations director first, then senior management inside the client's organisation.

Task 3: A consultation where concerns will come up

You are preparing for a second consultation with a company interested in cloud-based monitoring. Their information technology, or IT, leadership team has raised concerns about cost control and data protection. You expect detailed questions about migration and compliance and need to prepare a useful, consistent response.

Which tool do you prepare from?

Where in the sale is this?

What information do you need?

Who will see it?

Choose an audience: Customer-facing or Internal.

Choose a purpose: Tell a business story live; Share a concise follow-up; Prepare responses to concerns; Check specific product facts.

Choose a tool: Pitch deck; One-pager; Objection-handling guide; Product quick-reference sheet.

Retry hints - read after choosing

Pitch deck: Can this material help you respond to the specific concerns raised? Think about what you need to prepare before the call.

One-pager: Check whether this choice prepares you to discuss specific concerns, rather than restating the proposed benefits.

Product quick-reference sheet: Accurate product details may help, but the customer is asking how their concerns will be addressed. What else would you need to prepare?

Completed-plan explanation - compare when ready

Audience: Internal. Purpose: Prepare responses to concerns. Tool: Objection-handling guide.

This guide lists common concerns with recommended responses, supporting evidence and follow-up prompts. It helps you prepare a consistent explanation and identify what still needs checking for this customer. You saw this preparation role in the preceding guide example.

Where in the sale is this? A second consultation, where the client's concerns are the focus.

What information do you need? Company-recommended responses, supporting evidence and questions to clarify concerns about cost control, data protection, migration and compliance. Distinguish what is supported from what still needs checking.

Who will see it? Your team during preparation; the client hears your explanation.

Task 4: Minutes before a technical meeting

You are finalising your preparation for a technical meeting. The client's IT manager has emailed last-minute questions about uptime guarantees and data centre locations. You have only a few minutes to confirm accurate details before you join the call.

Which tool do you check before the call?

Where in the sale is this?

What information do you need?

Who will see it?

Choose an audience: Customer-facing or Internal.

Choose a purpose: Tell a business story live; Share a concise follow-up; Prepare responses to concerns; Check specific product facts.

Choose a tool: Pitch deck; One-pager; Objection-handling guide; Product quick-reference sheet.

Retry hints - read after choosing

Pitch deck: Does your choice let you locate the specific details requested in the few minutes available?

One-pager: Think about the level of detail needed to answer these last-minute questions. Would this choice provide it?

Objection-handling guide: Is the IT manager raising a concern to discuss or asking for a detail to check? Read the email again.

Completed-plan explanation - compare when ready

Audience: Internal. Purpose: Check specific product facts. Tool: Product quick-reference sheet.

This internal summary helps you locate service details such as documented uptime commitments, data centre locations and pricing. It is useful for a quick product-fact check; if a detail is missing or unclear, identify what needs confirmation rather than guess.

Where in the sale is this? A technical meeting, with time only for a last check.

What information do you need? Specific product details: documented uptime commitments, if any, and relevant data centre locations.

Who will see it? You use the reference to prepare an answer for the IT manager.

Compare tasks 3 and 4

Keep the same tool and internal audience while switching between the two tasks. Does it still support the information needed? Use the task hints, then compare the completed-plan explanations. You may reuse a tool; no resource quota applies.

Your preparation plan

Record your four choices and explanations. In the interactive version, complete all four tasks to download your own plan. Return to FutureLearn and mark the step complete there; this activity does not update your course completion.

Pitch decks and one-pagers are primarily customer-facing: one introduces the story and the other reinforces it. Objection-handling guides and product quick-reference sheets mainly support preparation, helping you respond to concerns and check product details. Choose by the task, intended audience and information needed. In the next step, a knowledge check asks you to apply these distinctions to new cases.